

**SUBSTITUTE FOR
HOUSE BILL NO. 5234**

A bill to amend 1949 PA 300, entitled
"Michigan vehicle code,"
by amending section 217c (MCL 257.217c), as amended by 2022 PA 224.

THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF MICHIGAN ENACT:

1 Sec. 217c. ~~(1) The secretary of state may conduct periodic~~
2 ~~reviews of the records of a dealer to determine whether adequate~~
3 ~~notice is given to a transferee or lessee of a rebuilt salvage~~
4 ~~vehicle of that vehicle's prior designation as a salvage vehicle.~~
5 ~~The secretary of state may request an insurance company to provide~~
6 ~~copies of salvage title documents and claims reports involving~~
7 ~~major component parts to assist the secretary of state in~~
8 ~~monitoring compliance with this act.~~

9 **(1)** ~~(2)~~ Except for a late model vehicle that has been stolen



1 and recovered and that has no major component part removed,
2 missing, or destroyed, or damaged and not salvageable, an insurance
3 company licensed to conduct business in this state that acquires
4 ownership of a late model vehicle through the payment of a claim
5 shall proceed under either of the following:

6 (a) If the insurance company acquires ownership of the vehicle
7 through payment of a claim, the owner of the vehicle ~~must~~**shall**
8 assign the certificate of title to the insurance company, which
9 shall do all of the following:

10 (i) Surrender a properly assigned certificate of title to the
11 secretary of state.

12 (ii) If the estimated cost of repair, including parts and
13 labor, is equal to or more than 75% but less than 91% of the
14 predamaged actual cash value of the vehicle, apply for a salvage
15 certificate of title, and if the estimated cost of repair,
16 including parts and labor, is equal to or greater than 91% of the
17 predamaged actual cash value of the vehicle, apply for a scrap
18 certificate of title. The insurance company shall not sell the
19 vehicle without first receiving a salvage or scrap certificate of
20 title, which ~~shall~~**must** be assigned to the buyer. An insurance
21 company may assign a salvage or scrap certificate of the title only
22 to an automotive recycler, used or secondhand vehicle parts dealer,
23 foreign salvage vehicle dealer, or vehicle scrap metal processor.

24 (b) If after payment of a total loss claim the insurance
25 company permits the owner of the vehicle to retain ownership, the
26 insurance company shall do all of the following:

27 (i) If the estimated cost of repair, including parts and labor,
28 is equal to or greater than 75% but less than 91% of the predamaged
29 actual cash value of the vehicle, require each owner of the vehicle



1 to sign an application for a salvage certificate of title, or if
2 the estimated cost of repair, including parts and labor, is equal
3 to or greater than 91% of the predamaged actual cash value of the
4 vehicle, require each owner of the vehicle to sign an application
5 for a scrap vehicle certificate of title.

6 (ii) Attach the owner's certificate of title to the application
7 for a salvage or scrap certificate of title or have the owner
8 certify that the certificate of title is lost.

9 (iii) On behalf of the owner, apply to the secretary of state
10 for a salvage or scrap certificate of title in the name of the
11 owner. The owner shall not sell or otherwise dispose of the vehicle
12 without first receiving a salvage or scrap certificate of title,
13 which must be assigned to the buyer. An insurance company may
14 assign a salvage or scrap certificate of title only to an
15 automotive recycler, used or secondhand vehicle parts dealer,
16 foreign salvage vehicle dealer, or vehicle scrap metal processor.

17 (2) ~~(3)~~ If an insurance company pays a claim for total loss to
18 the owner or lienholder of record as kept by the secretary of
19 state, or both, if applicable, of a vehicle but the owner or
20 lienholder of record as kept by the secretary of state fails to
21 surrender the certificate of title or other document necessary for
22 the transfer of ownership of the vehicle to the insurance company
23 ~~within the expiration of~~ **not later than** 30 days after the claim
24 payment, the insurance company, without having obtained the
25 surrender of the title or other document otherwise necessary for
26 the transfer of ownership for the vehicle from the owner or
27 lienholder of record as kept by the secretary of state, or both, if
28 applicable, may apply to the secretary of state for a title as
29 provided under this section. The insurance company shall, at the



time of application, provide proof of the payment and that the insurance company has requested in writing, by certified mail or by another commercially available delivery service providing proof of delivery, on at least 2 separate occasions that the owner or lienholder of record as kept by the secretary of state surrender to the insurance company the certificate of title or other document necessary for the transfer of ownership to the insurance company.

The application must be signed under the penalty of perjury.

Subject to subsection ~~(2) (a) (ii)~~, ~~upon~~ **(1) (a) (ii)**, on meeting the requirements of this subsection, the secretary of state shall issue to the insurance company the appropriate certificate of title free of all liens. Proof of payment of the claim is satisfied only by 1 of the following:

(a) In the case of payment by check, either of the following:

(i) A copy of the front and back of the endorsed check.

(ii) Evidence that the check has cleared the account of the payer.

(b) In the case of payment by electronic transfer, evidence that the payment was charged to the account of the payer.

(3) ~~(4)~~ Except as provided in subsection ~~(3)~~, ~~(2)~~, if an insurance company acquires ownership of a vehicle other than a late model vehicle through payment of damages due to an accident, the company shall surrender a properly assigned title to the buyer ~~upon~~ on delivery.

(4) ~~(5)~~ If a dealer acquires ownership of a ~~late model~~ vehicle that is a distressed vehicle from an owner, the dealer shall receive an assigned certificate of title. If the assigned certificate of title is not a salvage or scrap certificate of title, the dealer, other than a vehicle scrap metal processor,



1 shall surrender the assigned certificate of title to the secretary
2 of state, and if the estimated cost of repair, including parts and
3 labor, is equal to or greater than 75% but less than 91% of the
4 predamaged actual cash value of the vehicle, apply for a salvage
5 certificate of title, or if the estimated cost of repair, including
6 parts and labor, is equal to or greater than 91% of the predamaged
7 actual cash value of the vehicle, apply for a scrap certificate of
8 title ~~within~~**not later than** 5 days after the dealer receives the
9 assigned certificate of title. The dealer may sell a salvage
10 vehicle to another automotive recycler, used or secondhand vehicle
11 parts dealer, foreign salvage vehicle dealer, or vehicle scrap
12 metal processor by assigning the salvage certificate of title to
13 the buyer. Unless the vehicle is rebuilt, inspected, and
14 recertified under this section, if the vehicle is sold to a buyer
15 other than a dealer, application must be made for a salvage
16 certificate in the name of the buyer in the manner provided in this
17 act. The dealer may sell a scrap vehicle only to a vehicle scrap
18 metal processor. A vehicle scrap metal processor shall surrender an
19 assigned certificate of title to the secretary of state ~~within~~**not**
20 **later than** 30 days after acquiring a vehicle for which a
21 certificate of title was received. A vehicle scrap metal processor
22 shall surrender an assigned salvage or scrap certificate of title
23 to the secretary of state ~~within~~**not later than** 30 days after
24 acquiring a vehicle for which a salvage or scrap certificate of
25 title was received and report that the vehicle was destroyed or
26 scrapped.

27 (5) ~~(6)~~An application for a scrap certificate of title must
28 be made on a form prescribed by the secretary of state **and**
29 accompanied by a fee of \$15.00. The application must contain all of



1 the following:

2 (a) The complete name and current address of the owner.

3 (b) A description of the vehicle, including its make, style of
4 body, model year, fee category or weight, color, and vehicle
5 identification number.

6 (c) If the vehicle is a late model vehicle, a listing of each
7 major component part that was not salvageable.

8 (d) Further information as may reasonably be required by the
9 secretary of state.

10 (6) ~~(7)~~—The scrap certificate of title must authorize the
11 holder of the document to transport but not drive on a highway the
12 vehicle or parts of a vehicle, and assign ownership to a vehicle
13 scrap metal processor, automotive recycler, used or secondhand
14 vehicle parts dealer, or foreign salvage vehicle dealer. A
15 certificate of title must not again be issued for this vehicle. A
16 person shall not rebuild or repair a scrap vehicle and allow it to
17 retain the original vehicle identification number.

18 (7) ~~(8)~~—If a person, other than a dealer or insurance company
19 that is subject to subsection ~~(2)~~—(1) or ~~(5)~~,—(4), acquires
20 ownership of a distressed, late model vehicle, the person must
21 surrender the title or assigned certificate of title to the
22 secretary of state, and if the estimated cost of repair, including
23 parts and labor, is equal to or greater than 75% but less than 91%
24 of the predamaged actual cash value of the vehicle, apply for a
25 salvage certificate of title, or if the estimated cost of repair,
26 including parts and labor, is equal to or greater than 91% of the
27 predamaged actual cash value of the vehicle, apply for a scrap
28 certificate of title before the vehicle may be transported.

29 (8) ~~(9)~~—An owner of a vehicle may determine that a vehicle is



1 a scrap vehicle or a salvage vehicle without making any
2 determination as to the actual cash value of the vehicle.

3 (9) ~~(10)~~—If a leasing company, vehicle manufacturer, insurance
4 company not licensed to do business in this state, association,
5 repossession company, self-insured owner, financial institution,
6 governmental entity, or other company, institution, or entity, owns
7 a distressed, late model vehicle, the titleholder shall surrender
8 the title or assigned certificate of title to the secretary of
9 state and apply for a salvage certificate of title if the retail
10 cost of repair, including parts and labor, is equal to or greater
11 than 75% but less than 91% of the predamaged actual cash value of
12 the vehicle, or if the retail cost of repair, including parts and
13 labor, is equal to or greater than 91% of the predamaged actual
14 cash value of the vehicle, apply for a scrap certificate of title,
15 before the vehicle may be transported or sold. If ownership is
16 transferred, the owner must sell the vehicle only to a dealer that
17 is eligible to buy a salvage or scrap vehicle in this state unless
18 the owner complies with subsection ~~(13)~~. **(12)**. When a leasing
19 company, vehicle manufacturer, insurance company not licensed to do
20 business in this state, association, repossession company, self-
21 insured owner, financial institution, governmental entity, or other
22 company, institution, or entity, estimates the repair of a
23 distressed, late model vehicle for the purpose of determining
24 whether to apply for a salvage or scrap certificate of title, a
25 complete record of the estimate and, if the vehicle is repaired
26 before a transfer of ownership, a complete record of the actual
27 cost of the repairs performed and who performed the repairs must be
28 maintained for a minimum of 5 years by the leasing company, vehicle
29 manufacturer, insurance company not licensed to do business in this



state, association, repossession company, self-insured owner, financial institution, governmental entity, or other company, institution, or entity. The estimates and repair records required by this subsection must be available for unannounced inspections by a law enforcement agency or a representative of the secretary of state. The secretary of state may request a leasing company, vehicle manufacturer, insurance company not licensed to do business in this state, association, repossession company, self-insured owner, financial institution, governmental entity, or other company, institution, or entity to provide copies of title documents, repair estimates, claims reports involving major component parts, and actual cash value determination documents to assist the secretary of state in monitoring compliance with this act.

(10) ~~(11)~~—An application for a salvage certificate of title must be made on a form prescribed by the secretary of state **and** accompanied by a fee of \$10.00. The application must contain all of the following:

(a) The complete name and current address of the owner.

(b) A description of the vehicle, including its make, style of body, model year, fee category or weight, color, and vehicle identification number.

(c) An estimate of the cost repair, including parts and labor, and an estimate of the predamaged actual cash value of the vehicle.

(d) If the vehicle is a late model vehicle, a listing of each major component part that was not salvageable.

(e) Further information as may reasonably be required by the secretary of state.

(11) ~~(12)~~—The secretary of state shall issue and mail the



1 salvage certificate ~~within~~ **not later than** 5 business days after the
 2 time the application is received at the secretary of state's office
 3 in Lansing. Each salvage certificate of title must include a
 4 listing of each major component part that was not salvageable.

5 **(12)** ~~(13)~~ A salvage certificate of title authorizes the holder
 6 of the title to possess, transport, but not drive on a highway, and
 7 transfer ownership in, a vehicle. The secretary of state shall not
 8 issue a certificate of title or registration plates for a vehicle
 9 for which a salvage certificate of title was issued unless a
 10 specially trained officer described in subsection ~~(15)~~ **(14)**
 11 certifies all of the following:

12 (a) That the vehicle identification numbers and parts
 13 identification numbers are correct.

14 (b) That the applicant has proof of ownership of repair parts
 15 used.

16 (c) That the vehicle complies with the equipment standards of
 17 this act.

18 (d) That any repairs performed on the vehicle were done in a
 19 workmanlike manner, as certified on a form provided by the
 20 department by a properly licensed mechanic in the appropriate
 21 specialty. A properly licensed mechanic ~~described in~~ **under** this
 22 subdivision must not be the same individual as the specially
 23 trained officer making the certification of the vehicle as required
 24 under this subsection.

25 **(13)** ~~(14)~~ The certification required by subsection ~~(13)~~ **(12)**
 26 must be made on a form prescribed and furnished by the secretary of
 27 state in conjunction with the department of state police and must
 28 accompany the application that is submitted to the secretary of
 29 state for a certificate of title. An application for a certificate



1 of title must contain a description of each salvageable part used
 2 to repair the vehicle and any identification number affixed to or
 3 inscribed on the part as required by state or federal law. ~~Upon~~**On**
 4 satisfactory completion of the inspection as required by the
 5 secretary of state and other requirements for application, the
 6 secretary of state shall issue a certificate of title for the
 7 vehicle bearing the legend "rebuilt salvage".

8 **(14)** ~~(15)~~—An officer specially trained as provided by the
 9 secretary of state and authorized by the secretary of state to
 10 conduct a salvage vehicle inspection is any of the following:

11 (a) An employee of the department of state.

12 (b) An on-duty or off-duty police officer.

13 (c) A previously certified police officer who is appointed by
 14 the local police agency as a limited enforcement officer to conduct
 15 salvage vehicle inspections. The local police agency shall give
 16 this officer access to the agency's law enforcement information
 17 network system and the authority to confiscate any stolen vehicle
 18 or vehicle parts discovered during an inspection. The local police
 19 agency may give the officer the authority to arrest a person
 20 suspected of having unlawful possession of a stolen vehicle or
 21 vehicle parts. The local police agency shall not appoint a
 22 previously certified police officer whose certificate has been
 23 suspended, revoked, or denied under subsection ~~(16)~~**(15)**.

24 **(15)** ~~(16)~~—The secretary of state shall issue a certificate to
 25 an officer who is specially trained as provided by the secretary of
 26 state to conduct salvage vehicle inspections. Only a person who has
 27 a valid certification from the secretary of state may perform
 28 salvage inspections. The secretary of state on the secretary of
 29 state's own initiative or in response to complaints shall make



1 reasonable and necessary public or private investigations within or
 2 outside of this state and gather evidence against an officer who
 3 was issued a certificate and who violated or is about to violate
 4 this act or a rule promulgated under this act. Subject to
 5 subsection ~~(17)~~, **(16)**, the secretary of state may suspend, revoke,
 6 or deny a certificate after an investigation if the secretary of
 7 state determines that the officer committed 1 or more of the
 8 following:

9 (a) Violated this act or a rule promulgated under this act.

10 (b) Was, after an investigation, found responsible for a
 11 fraudulent act in connection with the inspection, purchase, sale,
 12 lease, or transfer of a salvage vehicle.

13 (c) Was found guilty of the theft, embezzlement, or
 14 misappropriation of salvage vehicle inspection fees.

15 (d) Performed improper, careless, or negligent salvage vehicle
 16 inspections.

17 (e) Ceased to function as a police officer because of
 18 suspension, retirement, dismissal, disability, or termination of
 19 employment.

20 (f) Was convicted of a violation or attempted violation of
 21 1986 PA 119, MCL 257.1351 to 257.1355.

22 (g) Made a false statement of a material fact in the officer's
 23 certification of a salvage vehicle inspection or any record
 24 concerning a salvage vehicle inspection.

25 (h) Charged a fee in excess of the fee described in subsection
 26 ~~(26)~~. **(25)**.

27 **(16)** ~~(17)~~—If the secretary of state revokes, suspends, or
 28 denies a certificate under subsection ~~(16)(a)~~, **(15)(a)**, (d), (g),
 29 or (h), the secretary of state shall, at the time of revocation,



suspension, or denial, notify the officer and the law enforcement agency on behalf of which the officer is performing inspections of the law enforcement agency's right to appeal the revocation, suspension, or denial. The notification must include a statement that a request for an appeal under this subsection must be made no later than 30 days after the revocation, suspension, or denial. An agency making an appeal under this subsection may request a hearing at the time the appeal is made. The secretary of state or any person designated by the secretary of state to act in the secretary of state's place shall deny or grant an appeal made under this subsection within a reasonable period, in writing or stated in the record if a hearing is held. If the secretary of state revokes a certificate under subsection ~~(16) (a)~~, **(15) (a)**, (d), (g), or (h) and denies an appeal of the revocation under this subsection, the officer may apply for a new certificate no earlier than 5 years after the revocation.

(17) ~~(18)~~ ~~Upon~~ **On** receipt of the appropriate abstract of conviction from a court and without any investigation, the secretary of state shall immediately revoke the certificate of an officer who has been convicted of a violation or attempted violation of section 413, 414, 415, 535, 535a, or 536a of the Michigan penal code, 1931 PA 328, MCL 750.413, 750.414, 750.415, 750.535, 750.535a, and 750.536a, or has been convicted in federal court or in another state of a violation or attempted violation of a law substantially corresponding to 1 of those sections.

(18) ~~(19)~~ If a dealer acquires ownership of an older model vehicle from an owner, the dealer ~~shall~~ **must** receive an assigned certificate of title and shall retain it as long as the dealer retains the vehicle. A vehicle scrap metal processor shall



surrender an assigned certificate of title to the secretary of state ~~within~~ **not later than** 30 days after the vehicle is destroyed or scrapped.

(19) ~~(20)~~ A dealer selling or assigning a vehicle to a vehicle scrap metal processor shall make a record ~~in triplicate on a form to be provided by the secretary of state in substantially the following form:~~

~~Scrap Vehicle Inventory:~~

SELLER: Dealer name _____
 Dealer address _____
 Dealer license number _____
PURCHASER: Conveyed to: _____ Date _____
~~(Vehicle scrap metal processor)~~
 Dealer address _____
 Dealer license number _____

~~Vehicles~~

					Dealer's Stock	
Model Year	Vehicle Make	VIN	Title Number	Number	Color	
1. _____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
2. _____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
3. _____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
etc.						

~~One copy must be retained as a permanent record by the dealer, 1 copy must be forwarded with the vehicle to be retained by the vehicle scrap metal processor, and 1 copy must be forwarded to the secretary of state.~~ **in a format, as determined by the secretary of state, that includes, but is not limited to, all of the following information:**



1 (a) The dealer's name, address, and license number.

2 (b) The scrap metal processor's name, address, and license
3 number.

4 (c) The date of the transaction.

5 (d) The vehicle's year, make, vehicle identification number,
6 dealer stock number, and color.

7 (20) ~~(21)~~—A person, other than an automotive recycler, used or
8 secondhand vehicle parts dealer, or a foreign salvage **vehicle**
9 dealer, receiving a salvage certificate of title shall not sell the
10 vehicle to anyone other than 1 of the following:

11 (a) The vehicle's former owner.

12 (b) A used or secondhand vehicle parts dealer.

13 (c) A vehicle scrap metal processor.

14 (d) A foreign salvage vehicle dealer licensed under this act.

15 (e) An automotive recycler.

16 (21) ~~(22)~~—A person receiving a scrap certificate of title
17 shall not sell the vehicle to anyone other than 1 of the following:

18 (a) An automotive recycler.

19 (b) A vehicle scrap metal processor.

20 (c) A foreign salvage vehicle dealer licensed under this act.

21 (d) A used or secondhand vehicle parts dealer.

22 (22) ~~(23)~~—The secretary of state may conduct periodic reviews
23 of the records of a dealer to determine whether adequate notice is
24 given to a transferee or lessee of a rebuilt salvage vehicle of
25 that vehicle's prior designation as a salvage vehicle. The
26 secretary of state may request an insurance company to provide
27 copies of salvage title documents and claims reports involving
28 major component parts to assist the secretary of state in
29 monitoring compliance with this act.



1 (23) ~~(24)~~—A licensed automotive recycler, used or secondhand
 2 vehicle parts dealer, vehicle scrap metal processor, vehicle
 3 salvage pool operator, distressed vehicle transporter, foreign
 4 salvage vehicle dealer, or broker that has removed a scrap vehicle
 5 from this state for the purpose of rebuilding the vehicle or
 6 selling or leasing the vehicle to a person other than a vehicle
 7 scrap metal processor, shall receive an automatic suspension of its
 8 dealer license and of any salvage vehicle agent's license assigned
 9 to that dealer for a period of 30 days. ~~Upon~~ **On** receipt by the
 10 secretary of state of a written request from the dealer, the dealer
 11 shall have the right to an immediate hearing on the matter within
 12 that 30-day period.

13 (24) ~~(25)~~—For the purpose of this section, the estimated costs
 14 of the repair parts must be determined by using the current
 15 published retail cost of original manufacturer equipment parts or
 16 an estimate of the actual cost of the repair parts. The estimated
 17 labor costs must be computed by using the hourly rate and time
 18 allocations that are reasonable and commonly assessed in the repair
 19 industry in the community where the repairs are performed.

20 (25) ~~(26)~~—A police agency shall charge a fee for an inspection
 21 of a vehicle under subsection ~~(13)~~. **(12)**. Each local authority with
 22 a police agency shall determine the amount of the fee for
 23 inspections by that police agency, ~~that~~ **but the fee** must not exceed
 24 \$100.00. Except as otherwise provided in this subsection, a fee
 25 collected under this subsection must be deposited with the local
 26 authority for that police agency. The records of the local
 27 authority regarding the collection and disposition of inspection
 28 fees is subject to review or audit by the local unit of government
 29 and must be made available ~~upon~~ **on** request to the department. If an



1 inspection was conducted by an employee of the department of state,
2 the fee must be deposited with the department of state. A fee
3 collected by a local authority must be used for law enforcement
4 purposes, ~~related to stolen vehicles,~~ including, but not limited
5 to, equipment, **training**, and road patrol services that ~~increase the~~
6 ~~likelihood of recovering stolen vehicles or stolen vehicle parts,~~
7 ~~and salvage vehicle inspections.~~ **are necessary to protect public**
8 **health or safety.** A fee collected by the department of state must
9 be used by the department for the administration of the salvage
10 vehicle inspection program and must not lapse to the general fund.
11 A local police agency may compensate an off-duty and limited
12 enforcement police officer for a salvage vehicle inspection.

13 (26) ~~(27)~~ For the purpose of this section, "actual cash value"
14 means the retail dollar value of a vehicle as determined by an
15 objective vehicle evaluation using local market resources such as
16 dealers or want ads or by an independent vehicle evaluation or
17 vehicle appraisal service or by a current issue of a nationally
18 recognized used vehicle guide for financial institution appraisal
19 purposes in this state.